

From The Shadows Into The Light

Spellforce 2: *Shadow Wars* provides great divergence from both beloved genres (RTS and RPG). Yet it's this combination that's thrillingly and intriguingly addictive!

Dark clouds threaten as the Shadows team up with the dark elves, and advance steadily towards the Kingdoms of Light. It's up to you—a Shaikan warrior—to save the world.

Gameplay

Spellforce 2 blends the RTS and RPG genres extremely well—you'll control your avatar char-

acter in RPG style, and his entire army in RTS fashion. Character evolution is deep, but not as much as a dedicated RPG, with regular fighter/archer and mage classes. The skill tree is highly hierarchical. There's a huge variety in equipment available, with a virtually unlimited inventory system.

Missions are very diverse, at times typically RTS-esque, other times very RPG-like—such as when exploring the countryside with just your party. The maps are very non-linear, encouraging you to explore, return to

complete quests and explore some more, very RPG-ish!

The epic single player storyline adds a good deal to the gameplay, while the actual game experience is engrossing enough to be a winner all by itself.

Multiplayer hasn't been ignored either, with the full campaign available for play co-op style for up to 3 players, multiplayer battles are also possible against human opponents.

Sights And Sounds

The world of Eo comes to life beautifully with the spectacular *Spellforce 2* engine. The graphics rock! Character animation is top class, (even NPC characters and units), movements are very lifelike, while the environments are simply breathtaking.

Battles are very well animated, with just the right touch of blood, and the spell and special feat effects look awesome! The game has a nice soundtrack with some voice acting is good, the sounds during battle are particularly notable, with the clangs of blade on shield, and the whoosh of a fire spell incinerating all those who oppose you.

This Spell Forces You To Play!

An epic storyline, Gameplay that involves you with a near perfect blend of genres, all this with swanky graphics and engaging gameplay make *Spellforce 2 Shadow Wars* a must play regardless of whether you're a fan of either genres or not.

michael_browne@thinkdigit.com

Rating: 9/10
Publisher: JoWood Games
Developer: Aspyr / Phenomic
Genre: RTS/RPG
System Requirements:
Pentium 4 1.6 GHz, 512 MB RAM, 128 MB
Direct X 9.0 compliant video card